AGILE TEAM CHARTER

QR Code Attendance Management System (QAMS) — Team QAMS

1. Team Purpose & Vision

Why do we exist as a team?

- **Team mission:** Build the QR Code Attendance Management System (QAMS), a web-based application that replaces slow, paper-based attendance registers with fast, fraud-resistant digital check-in — delivered for students, lecturers and administrators at CPUT as our Project Presentation 3 submission.
- **Success definition:** A working, deployed QAMS prototype that demonstrates time-limited QR code generation, real-time attendance capture, late-arrival flagging and role-based dashboards — signed off by our lecturer at the final review, with every team member able to present and defend their contribution.
- **Product / Service:** A full-stack web application (Vue.js + Bootstrap frontend, Spring Boot REST API, MySQL database) hosted on free-tier cloud services, supporting Student, Lecturer and Administrator roles, with source code on GitHub and a demo video.

2. Team Members & Roles

Who is on the team and how do we contribute?

Name	Role	Key Responsibilities
Vuyolwethu R. Piyo 222875437	**Product Owner**	Owns backlog, defines priorities, represents end-user needs, accepts completed work against acceptance criteria.
Milani Ncana 216269369	**Agile Lead (Scrum Master)**	Facilitates ceremonies, removes blockers, protects team focus, tracks progress on the board.
Ross Barth 220612986	**Developer**	Designs and implements features, writes clean maintainable code, reviews peers' pull requests.
Levi Williams 218250142	**Developer**	Designs and implements features, writes clean maintainable code, reviews peers' pull requests.
Isheanesu Chowuraya 223182192	**Developer / Analyst**	Translates requirements into user stories, assists with system analysis and technical documentation.
Reece Josephs 218152701	**Tester / QA**	Writes test cases, performs functional and regression testing, reports defects, verifies fixes.

3. Ways of Working

How we work together day to day

3.1 Agile Framework

☒Scrum (recommended — fits semester timeline with fixed sprints)

☐Kanban (continuous flow, no fixed sprints)

☐Scrumban (hybrid — Scrum ceremonies with a Kanban board)

3.2 Ceremonies

Ceremony	Frequency	Purpose
Daily Stand-up	Daily (15 min)	Each member shares: what I did, what I'll do, what's blocking me.
Sprint Planning	Every 2 weeks	Select stories from the backlog and commit to a realistic sprint goal.
Review / Demo	End of each sprint	Demo working software to the Product Owner / lecturer and collect feedback.
Retrospective	End of each sprint	Inspect how we worked: what went well, what to improve, one action item.

4. Working Agreements

Rules we agree to follow as a team

- We show up prepared and on time for every ceremony.
- We respect timeboxes — stand-ups stay under 15 minutes.
- We give constructive, specific feedback focused on the work, not the person.
- We raise blockers early — no silent struggling for more than half a day.
- We commit to continuous improvement and act on at least one retro action item per sprint.
- We never push directly to main — all changes go through a pull request with at least one reviewer.
- We keep the Kanban / sprint board up to date at the end of every working day.
- We ask for help before missing a deadline.

5. Communication

How and when we communicate

- **Primary channels:** WhatsApp group for quick updates; Microsoft Teams for calls, screen-shares and file sharing; GitHub Issues for technical tracking; email for formal communication with the lecturer.
- **Response-time expectations:** Messages during core hours (09:00–17:00 weekdays) answered within 2 hours. Urgent blockers flagged with @channel / @everyone. Non-urgent items answered within 24 hours.
- **Remote / hybrid norms:** Cameras on for planning, reviews and retros. Cameras optional for daily stand-ups. Mute by default when not speaking.

6. Decision-Making

How decisions are made

☒Consensus — default for technical and process decisions

☒Product Owner final decision — for scope and priority disputes

☐Team vote (majority) — when consensus cannot be reached in 10 minutes

☐Agile Lead decides after input — for process and tooling disputes

Escalation path if we're stuck: discuss in stand-up → raise in retro → Agile Lead calls a short decision meeting → lecturer consulted as last resort.

7. Definition of Done (DoD)

When is work really "done"?

- Code is written, compiles, and runs locally without errors.
- Code has been peer-reviewed via pull request and approved by at least one other developer.
- Feature is covered by at least one automated or documented manual test.
- Tests pass and no existing tests are broken.
- Role-based access (Student / Lecturer / Administrator) is respected for any new endpoint or screen.
- Features handling student data comply with POPIA basics — collect only what's needed, restrict access, log sensibly.
- README / user documentation has been updated where relevant.
- Product Owner has accepted the work against its acceptance criteria.
- Code is merged to main and deployed to the agreed demo environment (Vercel / Railway).

8. Core Values & Behaviours

How we treat each other

- **Respect:** Respect everyone's time, input and level of experience.
- **Transparency:** Share progress, blockers and mistakes openly — no hidden work.
- **Accountability:** Own your commitments; if something slips, communicate early.
- **Trust:** Assume good intent and trust each team member to deliver.
- **Learning mindset:** Treat every sprint as a chance to learn something new.

9. Risks & Constraints

What could impact our success?

- **Known risks:** Students without smartphones in class; unreliable classroom Wi-Fi during check-in; QR codes being screenshotted and shared remotely; server downtime during a live demo; low lecturer adoption if the interface is unclear; POPIA compliance on stored student data; clashing assessment deadlines across subjects; uneven Git/GitHub proficiency across the team.
- **Dependencies:** Lecturer sign-off on project scope; access to a shared GitHub organisation; availability of free-tier hosting on Vercel (frontend) and Railway / Render (backend + MySQL); access to a classroom projector or screen for displaying QR codes during demos.
- **Constraints (time, budget, tools, skills):** Fixed academic deadline (Project Presentation 3, June 2026); near-zero monetary budget — must stay on free tiers; ~120–160 developer hours distributed across 6 team members working part-time; limited prior experience with Spring Boot deployment and QR library integration; POPIA requires minimal data collection and explicit handling of student identifiers.

10. Review & Improvement

Keeping the charter alive

Charter reviewed every:

☐Quarter

☐Release

☒Retrospective (recommended for a student sprint cadence)

Last updated: 22 April 2026

11. Team Commitment

Our agreement to this charter

By working on this team, we commit to the principles and agreements outlined above.

Name & Student Number	Signature / Agreement
Vuyolwethu R. Piyo 222875437	
Milani Ncana 216269369	
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Levi Williams 218250142	
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